

Jingran Yang

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Last updated: September 7, 2026

EDUCATION

University of Kansas

Doctoral student in political science (Advisor: John James Kennedy)

Lawrence, KS, USA

Aug. 2023 – Present

Renmin University of China

Ph.D. in Economics (Advisor: Qijing Yang)

Beijing, CN

Sept. 2014 – Jun. 2020

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Visiting Student (Supervised by: Scott Gehlbach)

Madison, WI, USA

Sept. 2016 – Aug. 2017

Chongqing Technology and Business University

M.A. in Management (Advisor: Jirong Cai)

Chongqing, CN

Sept. 2012 – Jun. 2014

Jiangnan University

B.A. in Arts (Advisor: Bo Jiang)

Wuxi, CN

Sept. 2007 – Jun. 2011

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Researcher

*Environmentally Applied Refrigerant Technology Hub (EARTH),
NSF-funded interdisciplinary research project*

Aug. 2026 – Present

Lawrence, KS, USA

Affiliated Researcher

Research Center for Carbon-neutrality and Finance, CUFU

Apr. 2022 – Apr. 2023

Beijing, CN

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I study the social, political, and economic microfoundations that drive political regime transitions, social stability, and economic efficiency. I am also interested in experimental studies on the causes of political polarization.

PUBLICATIONS

Yang, Jingran. (2026). “**Misreading Social Identity Theory: Why Affective Polarisation Research Got It Wrong.**” *Political Studies Review*. [PDF]

Yang, Qijing and Jingran Yang. (2019). “**Promotion Tournaments: Contributions and Challenges of Tournament Theory**” (in Chinese). *Comparative Economic & Social Systems*, No. 2, pp. 156–164.

Yang, Jingran and Peiheng Wang. (2014). “**Tournament Incentives in Channel Management of Automobile Assembly Enterprises**” (in Chinese). *Systems Engineering*, No. 5, pp. 123–127.

WORKING PAPERS

“Competitive Dynamics in Organizations” (with Qijing Yang), Best Paper Award, Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy (IOEA), France, 2025.

“The Strategic Erosion of Competitive Elections in Rural China” (with John James Kennedy).

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Nature and Origins of Affective Polarization (with Ingles Nguyen Kristy)

Social Ties and Political Regime Transitions

AWARDS / GRANTS / FELLOWSHIPS

Awards

Best Paper Award, Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy (IOEA), France 2025.

Grants

Conference Travel Award, IOEA, supporting participation in the Society for Institutional and Organizational Economics (SIOE) Annual Conference, 2026.

APSA Democracy & Autocracy Section Travel Award, 2026.

APSA Travel Grant, 2026.

Walter Thompson Scholarship, 2025, 2024.

Ketzel Student Support Fund, 2026, 2025.

Graduate Student Travel Fund, 2024.

Fellowships

IPSR Doctoral Research Fellow, KU, 2025–2026.

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS (INCLUDING SCHEDULED)

2026 Political Science Speaker Series (Invited), IPSR Doctoral Fellows Symposium, Society for Institutional and Organizational Economics (SIOE), Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory, American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA).

2025 Institutional and Organizational Economics Academy (IOEA), Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference (MPSA), American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA) (poster).

2017 Chinese Economics Society Australia (CESA), UW–Madison.

MEDIA & RESEARCH DISSEMINATION (INCLUDING SCHEDULED)

2026 **Featured Author Interview**, Political Studies Review (SAGE / PSA)
Official journal interview discussing “Misreading Social Identity Theory: Why Affective Polarisation Research Got It Wrong.”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Kansas

- POLS 301 Introduction to Political Theory (Undergraduate, TA, Spring 2026)
- POLS 206 Political Science Methods of Inquiry (Undergraduate, TA, Spring 2025, Fall 2025)
- POLS 110 Introduction to American Politics (Undergraduate, TA, Fall 2024)
- POLS 150 Introduction to Comparative Politics (Undergraduate, TA, Fall 2023, Spring 2024)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Discussant

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA), 2026.

Undergraduate Research Mentoring

Kristy Ingles Nguyen, Undergraduate Research Assistant, 2024–present.